

Venezuelan Nobel Peace laureate Machado misses ceremony



STIAN LYSBERG SOLUM/NTB SCANPIX/AP

Ana Corina Sosa Machado, the daughter of Venezuelan opposition politician and Nobel Peace Prize recipient María Corina Machado, attends the Nobel Peace Prize ceremony at Oslo City Hall on Wednesday on her mother's behalf. Sosa said Machado had left Venezuela after nearly a year in hiding; she later arrived in Oslo. **Story, A11**

Boosting pressure on Venezuela, U.S. seizes oil tanker

NEW TACTIC IN CAMPAIGN AGAINST MADURO

Vessel was defying American sanctions, Bondi says

BY SAMANTHA SCHMIDT, MATT VISER, KAREN DEYOUNG AND MEG KELLY

U.S. forces seized an oil tanker near the Venezuelan coastline Wednesday, President Donald Trump said, a significant escalation in the U.S. pressure campaign against President Nicolás Maduro and his country's oil-dependent economy.

Attorney General Pam Bondi said the U.S. Coast Guard, the FBI and Homeland Security Investiga-

tions executed a seizure warrant for a crude oil tanker used to transport oil from Venezuela and Iran in defiance of sanctions.

The oil tanker had been sanctioned by the United States "due to its involvement in an illicit oil shipping network supporting foreign terrorist organizations," Bondi wrote on X on Wednesday evening. She also shared a video that shows U.S. forces jumping out of helicopters and searching the large vessel on foot.

Earlier Wednesday, Trump **SEE VENEZUELA ON A12**

An inside review of the order to kill 2 survivors

Between first and second hit, admiral faced most fateful choice of career

BY NOAH ROBERTSON, ALEX HORTON AND ELLEN NAKASHIMA

In the minutes after U.S. forces attacked a suspected drug smuggling boat near Trinidad, Adm. Frank M. Bradley, the commander overseeing the operation, faced a choice.

A laser-guided bomb had killed nine of the 11 people on board, sunk the boat's motor and capsized the vessel's front end,

according to people who have viewed or been briefed on a classified video of the operation. As smoke from the blast cleared, a live surveillance feed provided by a U.S. aircraft high overhead showed two men had survived and were attempting to flip the wreckage.

Ahead of the Sept. 2 mission, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had given an order to U.S. forces to kill the passengers, sink the boat and destroy the drugs, three people familiar with the operation said. It appeared to Bradley that none of those objectives had been achieved, the admiral would **SEE STRIKE ON A8**

Strike videos: House passes bill to pressure Hegseth for release. **A9**

A divided Federal Reserve cuts interest rates again

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

The Federal Reserve cut interest rates by a quarter of a percentage point on Wednesday for the third time this year, seeking to shore up a softening labor market even as inflation builds and leaving the prospect of more cuts next year unclear.

"It's a labor market that seems to have significant downside risks," Fed Chair Jerome H. Powell

Central bankers debate economy's mixed signals on inflation, labor market

said at a news conference after the meeting.

Though Fed officials tentatively penciled in at least one more rate cut before the end of next year,

estimates about where the economy is heading varied significantly, and Powell suggested the central bank might wait before returning to any additional cuts.

"We are well positioned to wait and see how the economy evolves from here," he said.

Wednesday's widely expected move lowers the Fed's benchmark rate to a range of 3.5 to 3.75 percent, the lowest level in about three years. But officials remain

sharply divided over how to respond to an economy sending mixed signals: Inflation remains above the Fed's target, which would typically argue for holding rates steady, while slower hiring and a modest uptick in unemployment suggest a case for easing.

Investors cheered the news, **SEE RATES ON A18**

Next Fed chair: Kevin Hassett, a Trump adviser, leads the race. **A14**

Migrants blocked from bond are fighting back

Immigration attorneys have been winning cases challenging detentions

BY ARELIS R. HERNÁNDEZ

The Trump administration's move to overturn years of legal precedent and require mandatory detention for all immigrants facing deportation has sparked outrage from advocates who say they are being denied due process.

Now, the migrants are fighting back in a torrent of legal challenges — and are on a winning streak in federal court.

Since September, when the mandatory detention policy took effect, judges have ruled overwhelmingly in favor of immigrants challenging the change, ordering the administration in case after case to hold immigration bond hearings for detainees or release them, according to a Washington Post review of hundreds of court cases.

In a decision that could have sweeping implications for thousands of detainees, U.S. District Judge Sunshine Sykes of the Central District of California ruled on Nov. 26 that the administration's policy is unlawful and said that the government must provide noncitizens across the country a chance to seek their release on bond.

She also granted class-action

status to all migrants subject to the administration's mandatory detention policy. The administration is likely to appeal, but immigration attorneys in Massachusetts and western Washington have secured similar class-action standing for detainees in their regions.

Those rulings are significant because the Supreme Court ruled in June that lower-court judges have exceeded their authority in issuing injunctions that ban the U.S. government from enacting policies across the country. However, the justices left open the door for judges to award nationwide injunctions in class-action cases.

"This is a classic example of the government putting their policy and agenda ahead of the law," said Matt Adams, legal director at the Northwest Immigrant Rights Project who serves as the lead attorney for the plaintiffs in the California case.

Not all migrants targeted for deportation face mandatory detention. Those who entered the country legally but overstayed their visas maintain the right to seek bond, including Bruna Ferreira, the former fiancée of White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt's brother Michael. A judge this week ordered Ferreira, 33, who is from Brazil but has lived in the United States since arriving with her family on a **SEE MIGRANTS ON A6**

DHS gets its own fleet: Agency will buy six planes for deportations. **A6**



JEHAD ALSHRAFI/AP

A treat for Gazans

A vendor in Gaza City sells cotton candy Wednesday. U.N. agencies have reported an increase in aid since the ceasefire came into effect but say the levels are still far below what is needed.

DCA crash families voice concerns over bill

BY LORI ARATANI AND TARA COPP

Family members of those killed in the January midair collision between a U.S. Army Black Hawk helicopter and an American Airlines regional jet are raising alarms about a provision in the defense funding bill that they say would allow the military to potentially restore flying procedures that may have been factors in the crash.

The nighttime collision that killed 67 people occurred over the Potomac River, just as the jet was in its final stages of landing at Reagan National Airport in Arlington, Virginia.

In the months since, the victims' families and lawmakers have homed in on the Army helicopter's lack of a critical positioning and communications system called ADSB-out. That technology, widely used in commercial aviation, emits a real-time track of an air-

craft's location and could have provided the control tower and other nearby airplanes critical information to prevent the accident.

The Army's 12th Aviation Battalion was operating the Black Hawk around National Airport on the night of the collision and was conducting a proficiency training flight, or check ride, that included flying parts of the unit's "continuity of government" mission — the potential evacuation from Washington. **SEE DCA ON A18**

Visa ban bars U.S. surgeons from critical work in Chad

Countries' mutual travel restrictions leave two doctors unable to operate

BY RACHEL CHASON

There were three surgeons serving Béré Adventist Hospital, a missionary clinic in rural Chad that is one of the only options for patients across Central Africa in desperate need of care.

Now, there is one.

The day after President Donald Trump issued a travel ban on citizens from Chad and 11 other nations, President Mahamat Déby announced a stop on visas for U.S. citizens, saying he had made the decision because Chad has "dignity and pride."

Two of the three American surgeons who kept Béré going — Andrew Trecartin and Stephen Waterbrook — are now stuck outside the country, fielding calls and messages from the patients and their families who had kept their operating room busy from 7:30 in the morning to long past sunset.

They say the situation has left dozens of people, including a toddler with a nonfunctional colon and a teenager with a worsening fistula, waiting for critical **SEE DOCTORS ON A13**

IN THE NEWS

Relief for Gaza Israel reopened the Allenby crossing in Jordan, a key corridor for relief supplies, as pressure builds to move the tenuous ceasefire into its second phase. **A10**

Mother's legal saga continues Catherine Hoggle is ruled fit for trial 11 years after her children vanished in Montgomery County. **B13**

THE NATION A second federal judge in New York ordered the release of documents on Jeffrey Epstein. **A3**
The Supreme Court will rule whether a man with low cognitive function may be executed. **A4**

THE WORLD Donald Trump again trashed London Mayor Sadiq Khan, whom he called "disgusting." **A11**
UNESCO named Italian cooking as a world heritage, sparking cheer and criticism. **A12**

THE ECONOMY The reliance on a Chinese-made power grid component is raising fears it can be used to trigger blackouts. **A14**

STYLE Tony Dokoupil, a co-anchor of "CBS This Morning," will helm the "CBS Evening News" desk in January. **B1**

SPORTS Michigan fired football coach Sherrone Moore after two seasons for an "inappropriate relationship" with a staffer. **B7**

THE REGION Maryland Gov. Wes Moore (D) called a special legislative session to select a new House speaker. **B13**

OBITUARIES Madeleine Wickham, the "chick-lit goddess" who wrote the Shopaholic novels under the name Sophie Kinsella, died at 55 of cancer. **B1**

WEEKEND Welcome to a Ralph Lauren Christmas, a holiday microtrend with velvet, bows and plaid.

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